The Big DESTINATIONS

Jaipur

The world-famous Pink City of Jaipur was planned by a young Bengali architect, Vidyadhar Bhattacharya, and built by Sawai Jai Singh II in 1727 AD. Laid in a neat grid, straight roads crisscross the city and are lined with shops on either side of the main bazaars. Planned along the lines of the principles of Hindu architecture, the Pink City, as it is called, displays remarkable harmony in its buildings, fairy tale palaces and rugged fortresses placed strategically on hills.

Today, this vibrant capital city of Rajasthan displays a blend of tradition and modernity. Neatly laid out parks and gardens punctuate the timeless appeal of its vibrant bazaars, where you can pick up gorgeous Rajasthani handicrafts, garments and jewellery.

Jaipur has many sights worth taking in. The City Palace, which lies in a sprawling walled enclosure with a ceremonial Tripolia Gate, is a blend of Mughal and Rajput architecture and was built by Maharaja Sawai Jai Singh II. It houses a spectacular museum with sections devoted to the royal wardrobe, armoury, jewellery, miniature paintings, photographs, and so on. You can also see a pair of silver vessels, 1.5 metres tall, and said to be the largest silver objects in the world.

A UNESCO World Heritage Site, Jantar Mantar is an astronomical observatory built by Sawai Jai Singh which has instruments made out of marble and stone which are used to make observations about the movement of celestial bodies.



Mehrangarh Fort, Jodhpur